

"IF WE CAN CELEBRATE CHILDREN'S DAY, WHY NOT KISAN DAY?"

PRAMOD PUSHKARNA



Raj Narain

The irrepressible Raj Narain not only challenged the authority of Indira Gandhi and ultimately led to her downfall in the elections of 1977, but also beat her in her own stronghold in Uttar Pradesh, Rae Bareilly. When the court upheld the petition filed by the bandanna-donning Narain, accusing her of fraud in the 1971 polls, she became the first Indian prime minister to testify—for five hours in the Allahabad High Court.

RETURN OF THE LION

Sheikh Abdullah, the Sher-e-Kashmir, had proclaimed himself the 'prime minister' of Jammu and Kashmir in 1948. He had demanded autonomy for the state in 1953. For all this, he was jailed for 11 years. After an exile, Abdullah was back to being the polestar of Kashmir in 1975 after Indira Gandhi reassured him that the special status conferred on the state by Article 370 would stay. The leader of the National Conference returned as chief minister in 1977, 23 years after being forced to give it up.



"KITNE AADMI THE?"

One of the biggest blockbusters in Bollywood history, G.P. Sippy's *Sholay*, with its impressive cast and memorable dialogues, caught the fancy of a nation steeped in drama. Gabbar's "kitne aadmi the" and Amitabh's "Basanti, tumhara naam kya hai" are enshrined in every cinema-goer's memory. The first Indian film to be made in 70mm, *Sholay* ran for five years, with 190 prints being made in the first year. Over five lakh records and cassettes were sold soon after the release.

ELSEWHERE...

- The Suez Canal, connecting the Mediterranean and Red seas, was reopened by Egypt eight years after it was closed due to the war with Israel.
- Mozambique became independent after almost five centuries of Portuguese rule.
- Sheikh Mujibur Rehman was assassinated in Bangladesh on August 15.
- Margaret Thatcher

AFF



(above) was elected the first ever woman leader of the British Conservative Party.

676

people were jailed on the day the Emergency was declared.

360 kg

was the payload of the first Indian satellite, Aryabhata. Designed by the ISRO, the satellite was launched into orbit on April 19.